negotiators on the planet—people like Jack Warner, Y. Frank Freeman, the president of Paramount, MGM's Louis B. Mayer, and the heads of the other studios.

When I began entering into the give and take of legislative bargaining in Sacramento, a lot of the most radical conservatives who had supported me during the election didn't like it. "Compromise" was a dirty word to them and they wouldn't face the fact that we couldn't get all of what we wanted today. They wanted all or nothing and they wanted it all at once. If you don't get it all, some said, don't take anything.

I'd learned while negotiating union contracts that you seldom got everything you asked for. And I agreed with FDR, who said in 1933: "I have no expectations of making a hit every time I come to bat. What I seek is the highest possible batting average."

If you got seventy-five or eighty percent of what you were asking for, I say, you take it and fight for the rest later, and that's what I told these radical conservatives who never got used to it.

Although the first year or so in Sacramento was hard going for us at times, Nancy and I had learned a lot.

For years, I'd been giving speeches about the problems in government. Now, after being dragged kicking and screaming into public office at a time when the state was facing a real emergency and I was uncovering problems I hadn't even known existed before, I'd been given a chance to do something about them.

As cumbersome as they were, I was at the controls. It was exciting. Suddenly, instead of just trying to rouse people to act, the problems were mine to deal with and it was a lot more fun than just talking about them.

As we finished dinner, Nancy and I agreed my new job made everything we'd ever done before seem as dull as dishwater.